



How to Learn Vocabulary Effectively & Not Forget It

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Helping you Become a Confident English Speaker

Many IELTS students lack confidence in their speaking skills.

The Keith Speaking Academy helps you develop your speaking skills so you can face the examiner with confidence and ace the IELTS test.

This PDF is one of many that Keith has developed to help you do this.



Keith has been working in international education for over 20 years as a teacher, teacher trainer, and education manager.

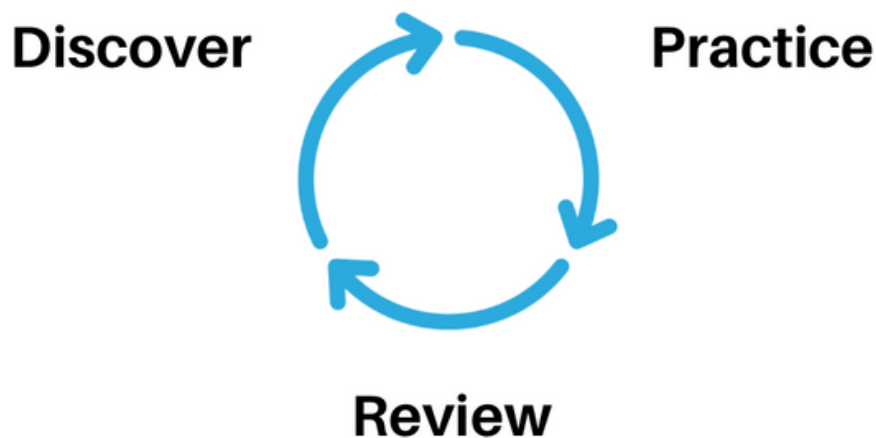
He has helped over 40,000 students prepare for their IELTS Speaking test with his online courses.

Learning English is an exciting journey, particularly when it comes to developing your speaking skills for your **IELTS Speaking test**.

However, the process of **vocabulary** learning can often feel daunting, with students struggling to retain new words. But here's the good news: it's not as hard as it might seem.

Many people mistakenly believe that learning vocabulary is just about memorising words, reciting them or exposing oneself to lots of English. While these methods are helpful, they are not the entire picture.

Learning vocabulary effectively isn't a linear process; it's a continuous cycle of **Discover**, **Practice**, and **Review**. Let's break this down and see how you can use this to help you learn vocabulary and not forget it.



The Circle of Effective Vocabulary Learning

Many people think learning vocabulary is a linear process where you just keep learning new words and adding them to your notebook. They think it is similar to shopping.

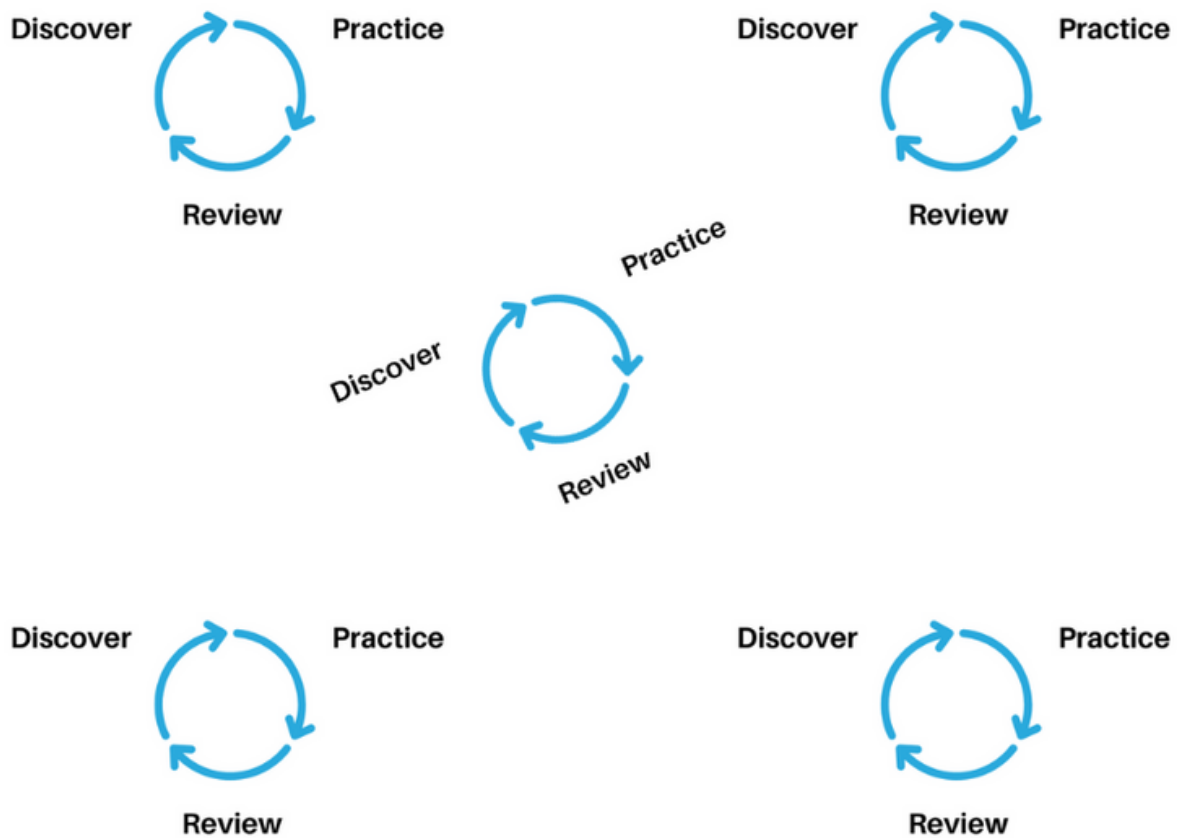
So, when you learn vocabulary for a different topic, such as 'sports' or 'clothes', it's like walking into a number of different shops, such as a sports shop or a clothes shop. When you learn a new word it's like buying an item in that shop and putting it into your shopping bag.

However, this is not the way to learn vocabulary effectively. You will most likely forget most of those words, in the same way you forget about a lot of the items you have bought, after you put them in your wardrobe when you get home.

The problem is, even though you've accumulated these words, they're still in your bag (or your notebook book) and not in your head.

You can't access them or use them easily or correctly.

In fact, learning vocabulary is a circular process, not a straight line. That process of discovering words, practicing and reviewing them is a circle, and you have lots of little circles moving, changing and even overlapping with each other, as you learn new vocabulary.



So, to learn vocabulary so you don't forget it, you should follow these three steps:

1. **Discover**
2. **Practice**
3. **Review**

Let's look at each of these in detail:

Discover

Discovery is the first step towards learning new vocabulary. It involves finding a new word, understanding its meaning, form, pronunciation, and how it's used in context. To learn vocabulary effectively, you should aim to discover words in context, rather than just memorising word lists.

For instance, consider the word "shop." You can learn its

- **meaning (to buy things)**
- **word form (verb)**
- **pronunciation (/ʃɒp/)**
- **a chunk or collocation such as "shop around" (=to compare prices).**

A good language learner is like a **detective**; you need to first determine whether the word is essential and then investigate it.

Practice

Practicing is the stage where you actively use the new word. For example, once you've learned the basics about the word "shop" and its collocation "shop around," you can practice using it in various ways.

A simple system I use in my **GOLD online course** is the **Speaking Success System**. The great thing about this is you can do it on your own at home.

It involves changing one word in a sentence. Then repeating and repeating, changing a different word each time.

You can change nouns, tenses of verbs or even subjects and pronouns.

Here is an example, where I change first the noun twice, and then the tense, and finally the subject.

"I am shopping around for a new **jumper**"

"I am shopping around for a new **car**"

"I am shopping around for a new **phone**"

"I **was** shopping around for a new phone."

"**She** was shopping around for a new phone."

Finally, you can also invent your own sentences, saying something that is true for you.

"I **hate shopping around**, but my wife **always shops around** when we buy something new"

By practicing, you breathe life into the vocabulary, taking it out of your bag (or book) and placing it firmly in your mind.

Review

Reviewing is the final step in this circular learning process. Here, you get feedback and deepen your understanding of the new vocabulary. This feedback could come from a teacher or even other students.

It might also come from a real life experience using the new vocabulary. If you live in an English-speaking country and you go into a shop and say to the assistant,

"I am going to shop around your prices with other shops,"

When the assistant looks at you in a strange way, you may realise something is not quite right. This is direct feedback. When you ask what's wrong, if you are lucky, they may explain and say you should say something like,

"I am going to shop around for better prices."

Another way of getting feedback is by seeing or hearing the word used in different contexts. This is why I give my students mini-stories in the **GOLD course**, so they are exposed to the new vocabulary in a different context.

You learn words more deeply when you see them in different contexts. Each new context reinforces your understanding. This is why trying to continually exposing yourself to the word in new contexts is essential to learning vocabulary effectively.



Conclusion

The cyclical methodology of **Discover**, **Practice**, and **Review** is an effective vocabulary-learning strategy that I incorporate into my GOLD online course.

This approach involves discovering new vocabulary via videos of IELTS Speaking model answers, practicing chunks with recorded videos, as well as in real-time breakout rooms with other students, and finally reviewing with quizzes and mini-stories.

Learning vocabulary is a long process, but it's an enjoyable one. Embrace the journey, be patient, and foster a curiosity for language.

Remember, you're not just learning words; you're becoming a vocabulary detective!

Find lots more resources at

WWW.KEITHSPEAKINGACADEMY.COM

